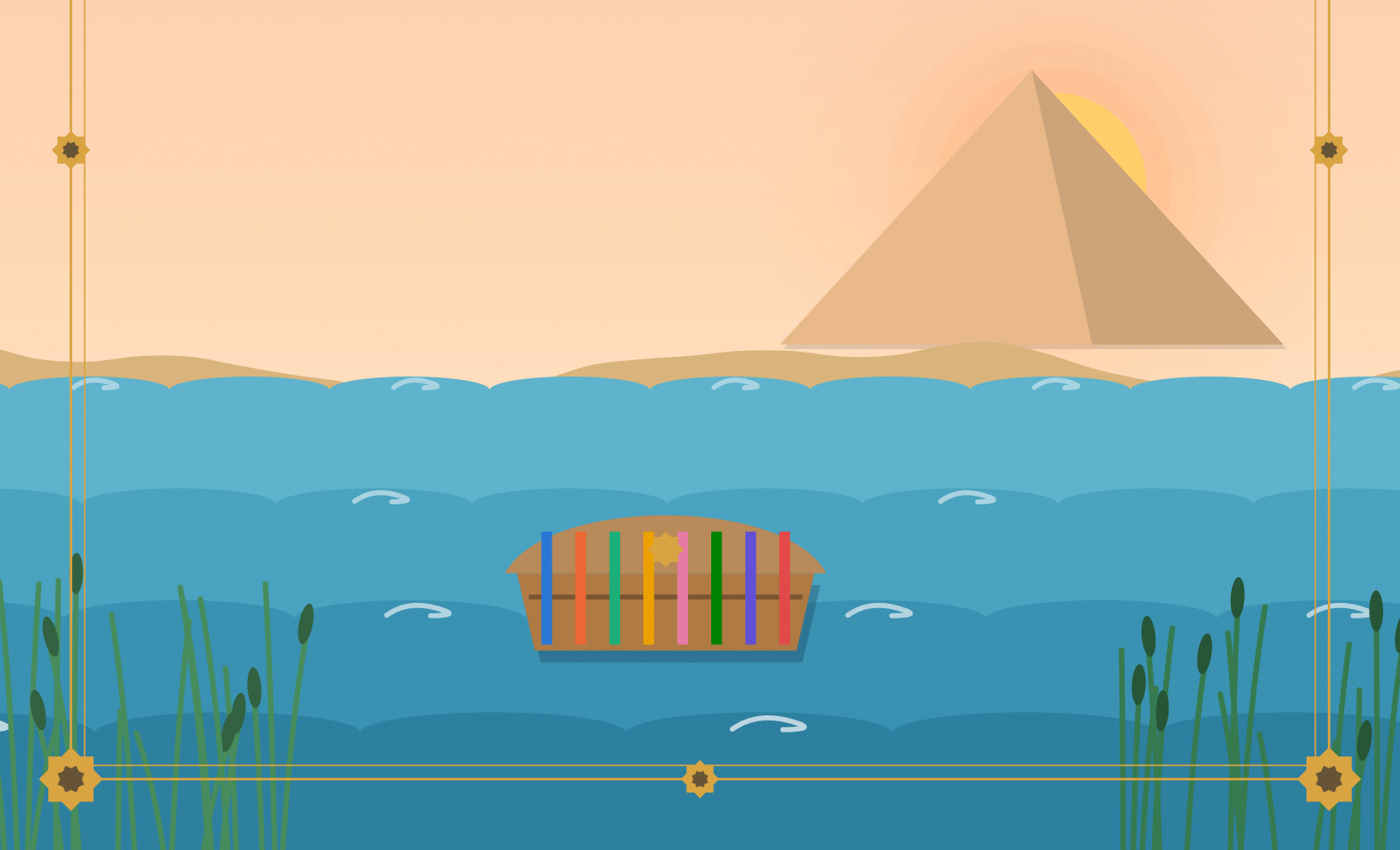
STORIES FROM THE QURAN · 4

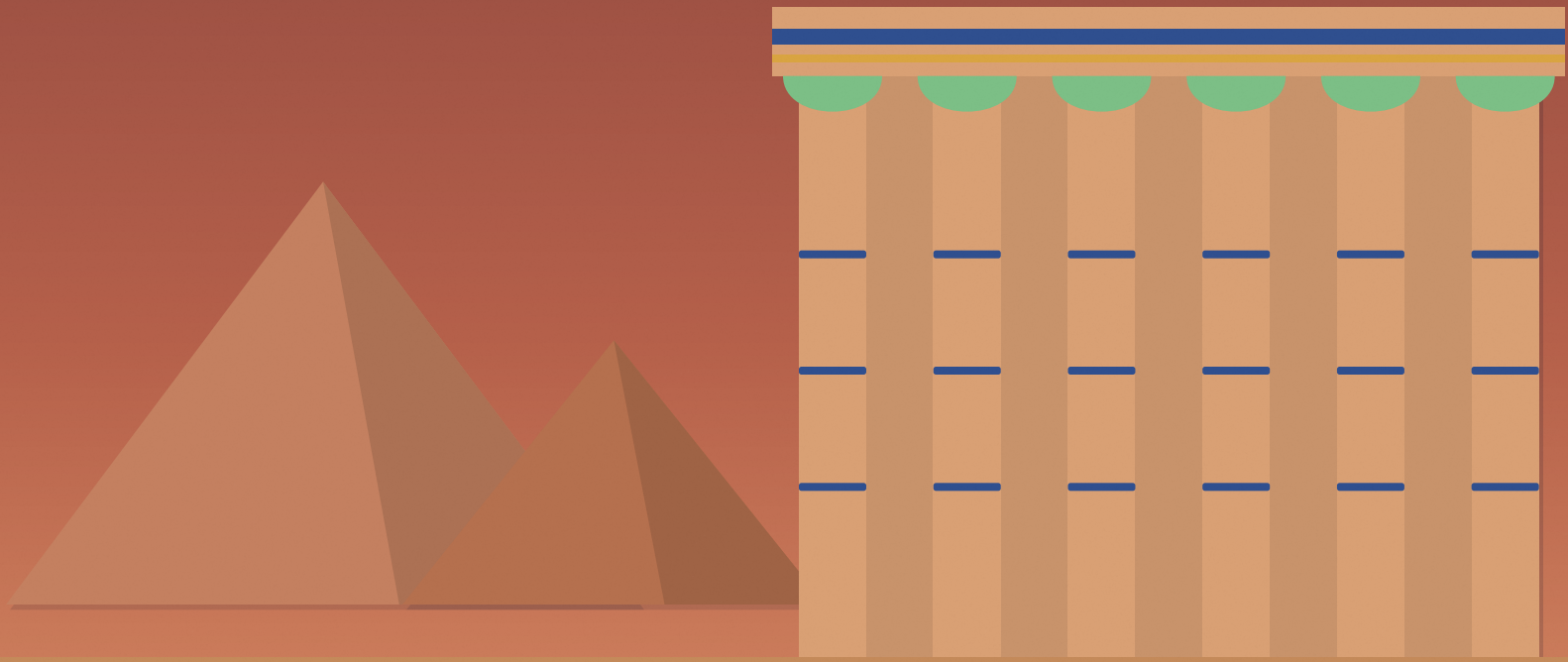
Musa and the River

موسى والنهر



Long ago in Egypt, beside the great river Nile, there was a cruel king called Pharaoh. He made the Children of Israel work as his slaves.

Pharaoh was afraid of them, and he gave a terrible order against their baby boys.



In one of their homes, a baby boy was born. His name was Musa (peace be upon him).

His mother held him close. She loved him so much, and she was very afraid for him.







Then Allah put a message in her heart:

“Feed your baby. And when you are afraid for him, put him in the river. Do not be afraid, and do not be sad. We will bring him back to you, and We will make him one of Our messengers.”



So she laid baby Musa in a wooden chest, closed the lid, and set it gently on the water.

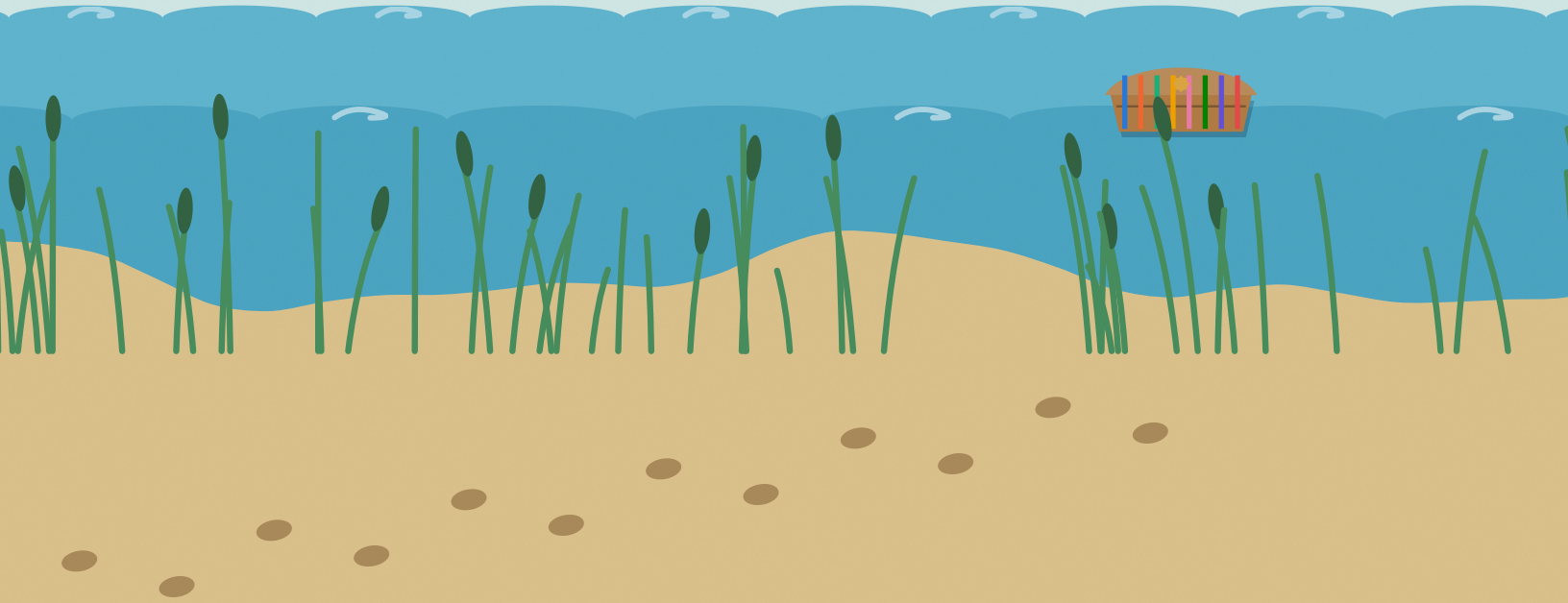
Allah had told the river to carry him, and to leave him on the bank.



Down the great river floated the little chest, past the reeds and the lotus flowers, past the palm trees and the birds.

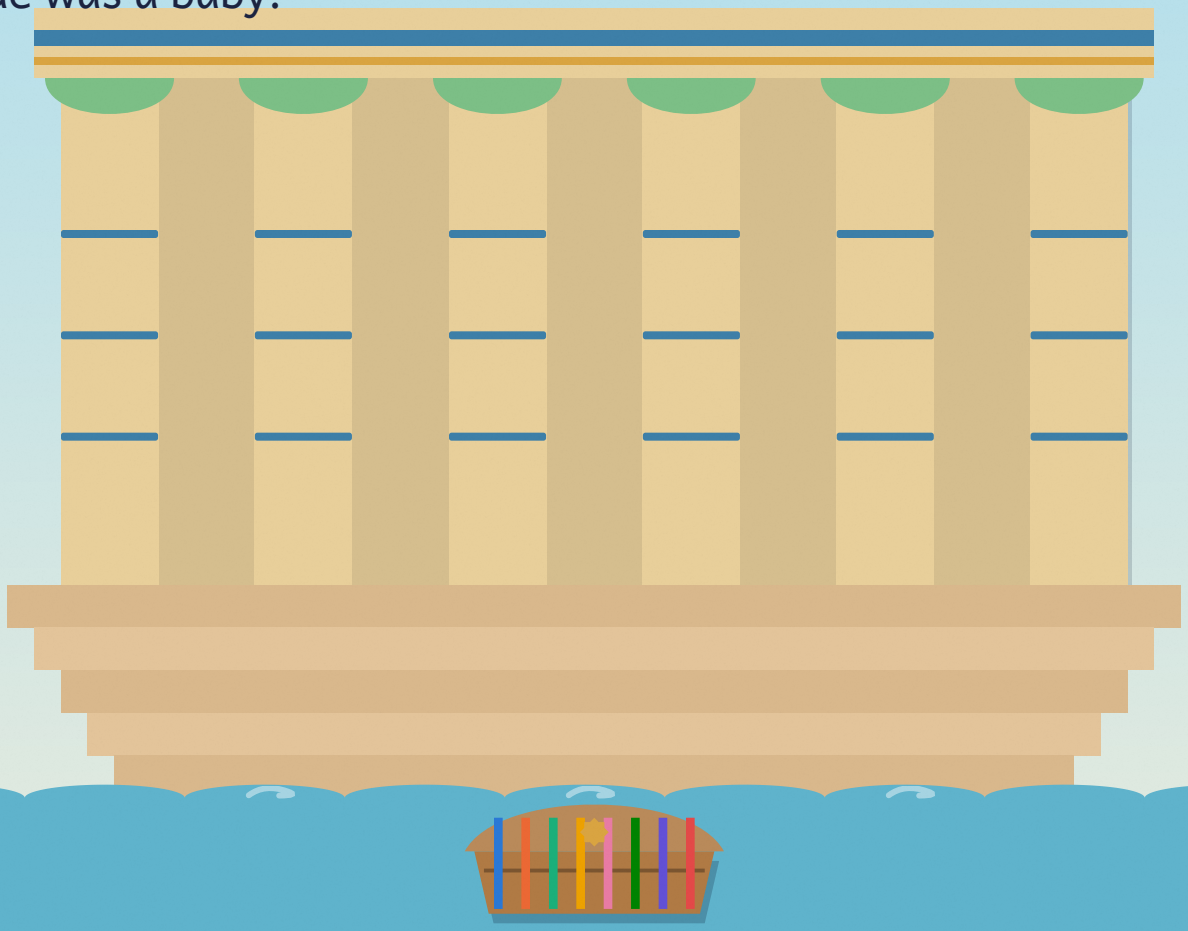


“Follow him,” Musa’s mother told his sister. So she walked along the riverbank, watching the chest from far away, so that no one would notice her.

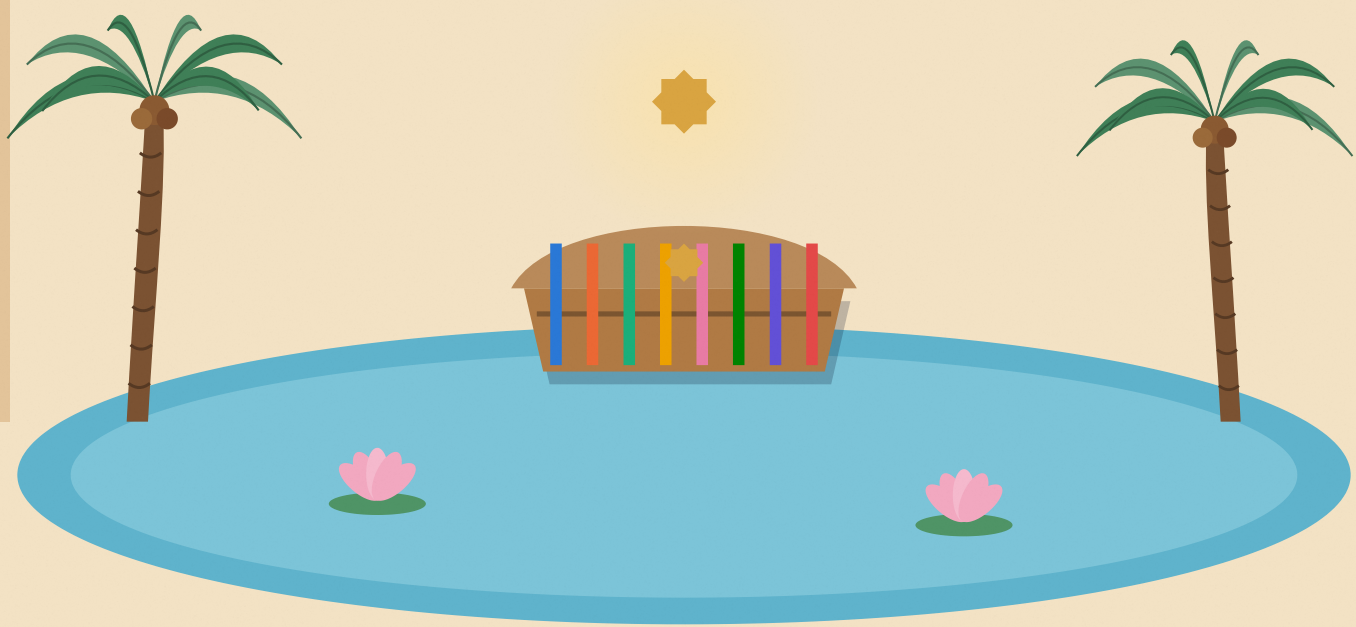


The river carried the chest right to the steps of Pharaoh's palace. Pharaoh's family lifted it out of the water and opened it.

Inside was a baby!



Pharaoh's wife loved the baby at once. "He will be a comfort to my eyes, and to yours," she said to Pharaoh. "Do not kill him. Maybe he will help us, or we can adopt him as our son."



Back at home, Musa's mother's heart felt empty. She almost told everyone her secret.

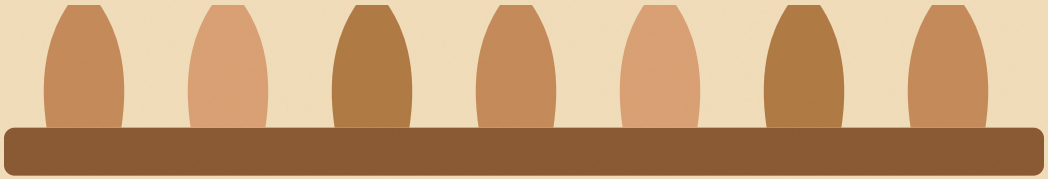
But Allah made her heart strong, so that she would trust His promise.





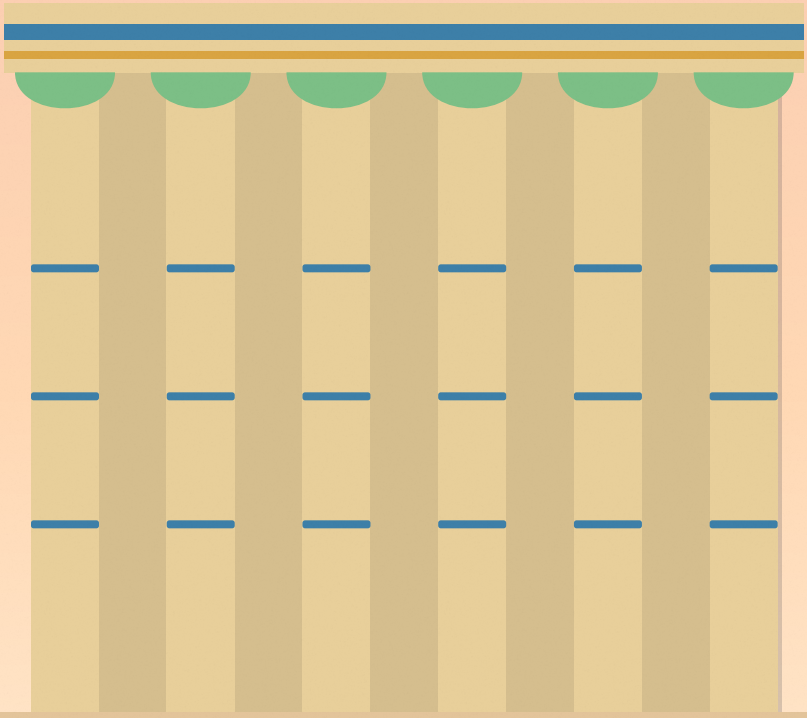


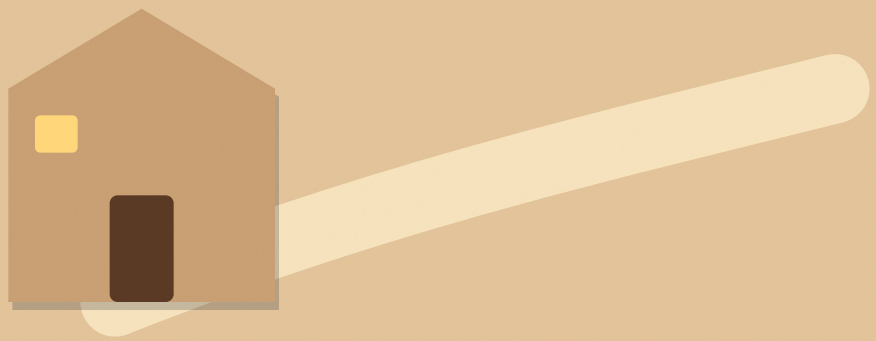
In the palace, the baby was hungry. They brought nurse after nurse to feed him. But Musa refused every single one!





Then his sister came to the palace. “Shall I show you a family who will feed him and care for him kindly?”





And so Allah brought baby Musa back to his mother, so that her eyes would be comforted, and she would not be sad, and she would know that Allah's promise is true.







Musa grew up in Pharaoh's palace. He became strong, and Allah gave him wisdom and knowledge.



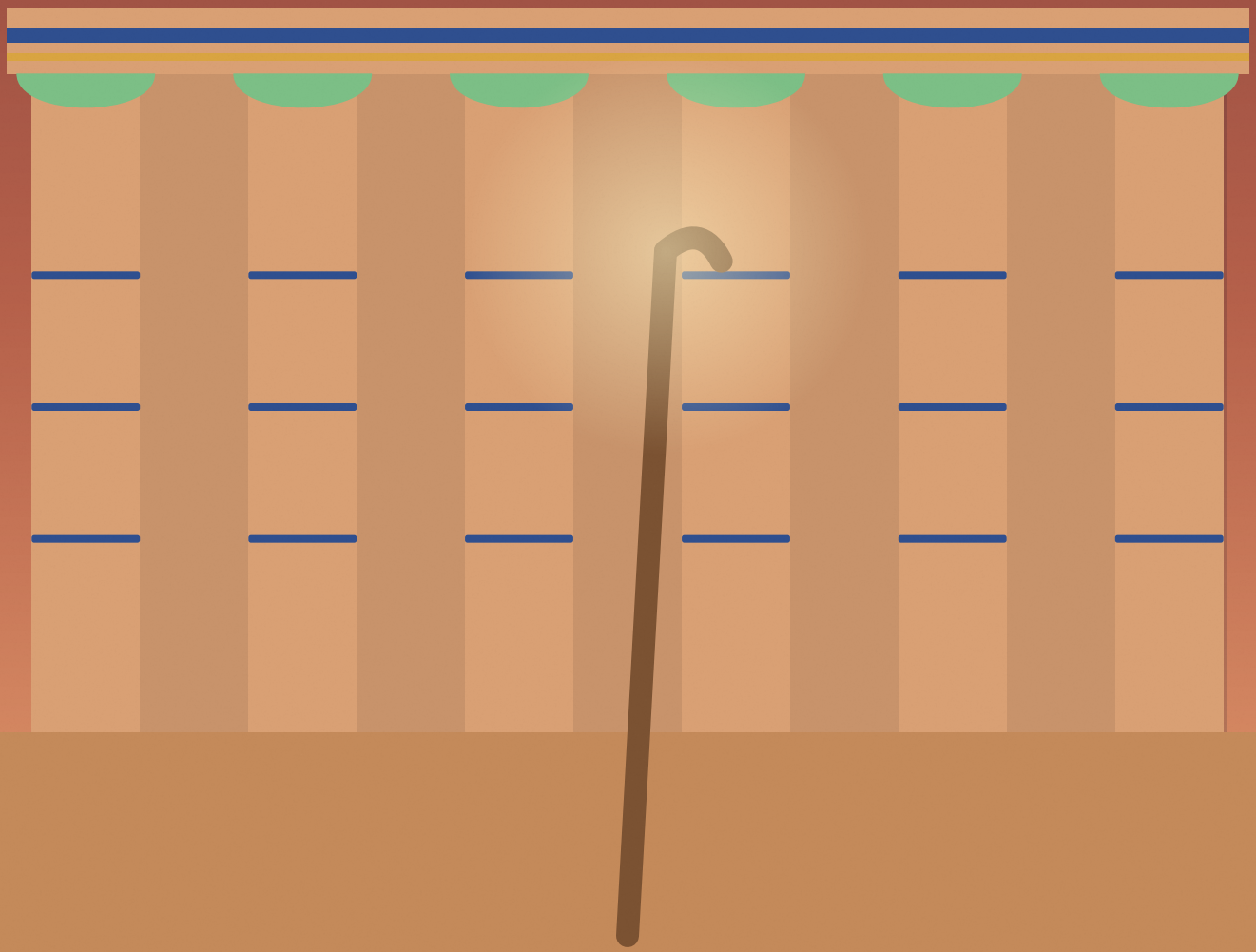
Many years later, far away in a quiet valley, Musa saw a fire on the mountainside. When he came close, Allah spoke to him.

“O Musa, I am Allah, Lord of all the worlds.” Allah made him a messenger.

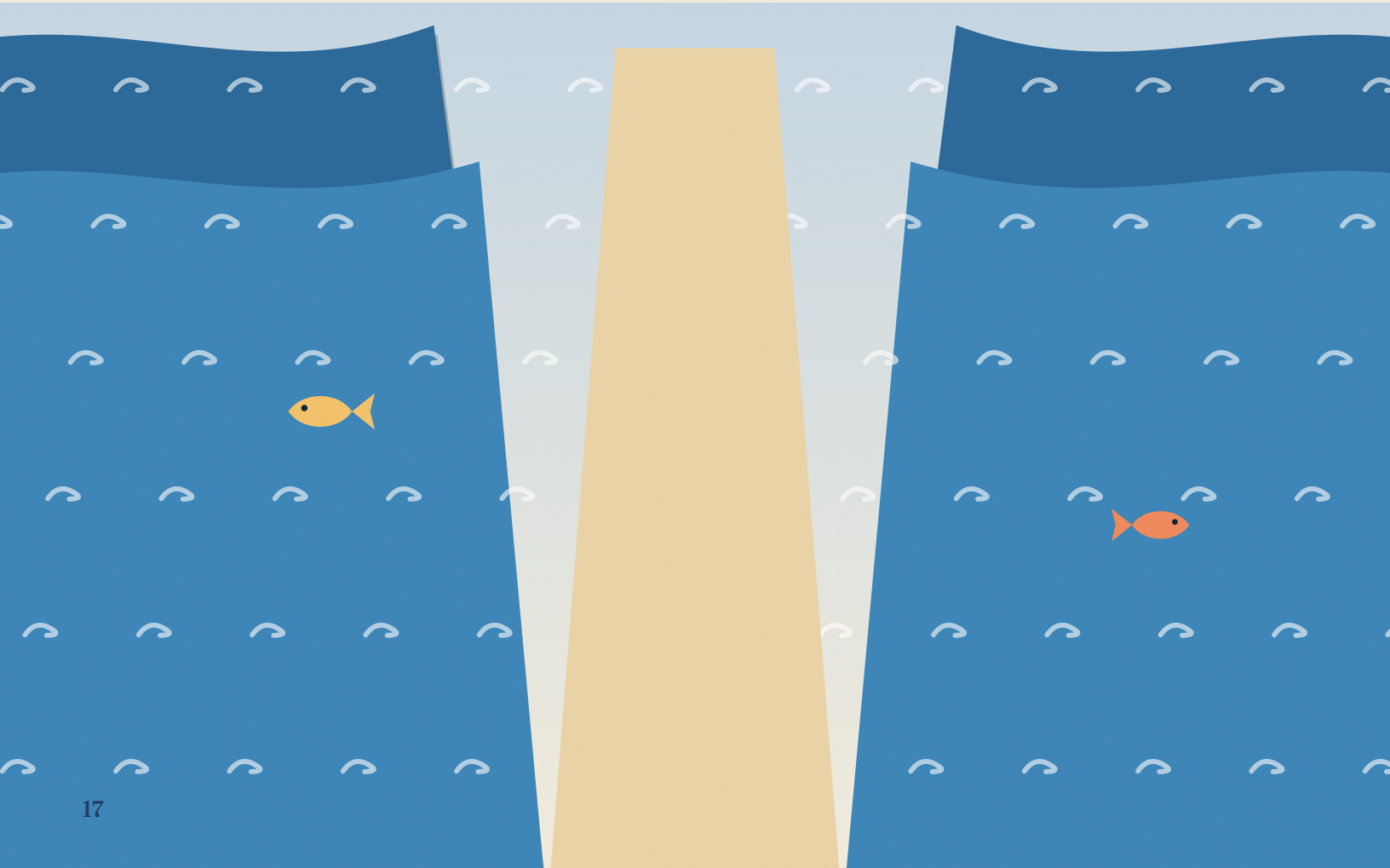


Allah sent Musa back to Egypt, to Pharaoh, with wonderful signs: his staff and a hand that shone with light.

“Let the Children of Israel go with us,” said Musa. But Pharaoh would not listen.



When Musa led his people out of Egypt, they came to the sea. Allah told Musa to strike it with his staff, and the sea split in two, like two great mountains, with a dry path between.



The baby in the chest had become a messenger of Allah, just as Allah had promised his mother on that frightened night.

Allah always keeps His promise.



Say Musa’s prayer

Musa prayed this when Allah sent him to Pharaoh. You can say it before something hard, like a test or a new school.

رَبِّ ٱشْرَحْ لِى

Rabbish-raḥ lī ṣadrī

My Lord, open my heart for me,

وَيَسِّرْ لِىٓ أَمْرِى

wa yassir lī amrī

and make my task easy for me.

From Surah Ta-Ha, 20:25–26

What does the story teach us?

Allah keeps His promises.
He promised to bring Musa back to his mother, and He did.

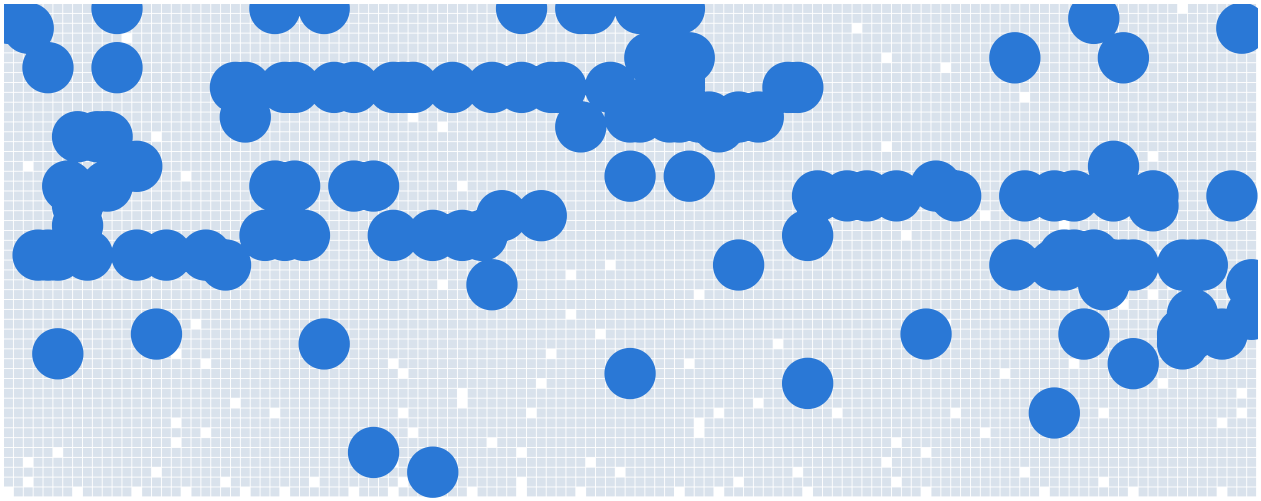
Be brave.
Musa's mother was afraid, but she trusted Allah.

Allah looks after the small and the weak.
A tiny baby in a box on a big river was safe.

Ask Allah to make things easy.
Say Musa's prayer before something hard.

Did you know?

Musa's name appears **136** times, more than any other person in the Quran. Look how the dots are spread right through the book!



Every verse of the Quran is one tiny square, starting at the top right like a page of the Quran. Each dot is a verse that names Musa.

His story is never told all in one place. Eight surahs tell many parts of it, and the Quran Atlas draws them as a train map, one coloured line for each.

Look closer

Some pictures hide a secret from the Quran itself. Go back and find them.

p. 5, 17	The river and the sea. The river that carried baby Musa (28:7) and the sea that later swallowed Pharaoh (28:40) are the same Arabic word: *al-yamm*.
p. 5	Eight coloured ribbons on the chest: the eight surahs that tell Musa's story at length, the eight lines of the Atlas train map.
p. 9, 13	Two golden stars. "A comfort to my eyes," said Pharaoh's wife (28:9). Allah used the same words for his mother: "so that her eyes would be comforted" (28:13).
p. 4, 18	Allah's promise had two parts: "We will bring him back to you, and make him a messenger" (28:7). Both came true.
p. 10	The empty cradle. The Quran says her heart became "empty" (28:10).

For parents

Where the story is told. Al-Qasas 28:3–14 (the birth, the river, the palace and the return), Ta-Ha 20:37–40 (the chest), Al-Qasas 28:29–32 (the fire in the valley and the signs), Ash-Shu'ara 26:60–66 (the sea).

Told in simple words. This is a retelling for young children, not a translation. Pharaoh's order against the baby boys (28:4) is mentioned only gently. The last four story pages leap ahead many years to show how the promise of 28:7 was kept; the full story of Musa fills many surahs.

The pictures. By custom, no prophet is drawn, and in this series no person at all. The pictures show the places, the light and the creatures, so your child can picture the story around them.

Talk about it. Musa's mother was very brave. When have you had to be brave? What helped?

Illustrators welcome. These first pictures are a starting point. Artists are invited to redraw any book; the Books page of the Quran Atlas has a brief for every page.

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